



PLAIN-LANGUAGE USER GUIDE

Hiring, made clear.

A simple guide to requesting a role, reviewing candidates, arranging interviews, and keeping recruitment moving.

Who is this for?

People who request new staff, HR teams, department heads, managers, recruiters, interviewers, and administrators.

What this portal helps you do

The portal keeps the whole hiring request in one place. What you can see and change depends on your access, so some menu items may not appear for you.

1 Sign in and find your way around
Dashboard, menu, profile, and access

2 Request a new role
Staff addition or replacement

3 Review and approve requests
HR, department, and management steps

4 Prepare a role for hiring
Screening and interview setup

5 Screen and manage applicants
Resumes, reviews, decisions, and notes

6 Arrange interviews
Available times, bookings, and attendance

7 For candidates
Apply and choose interview times

8 Help and good practice
Common problems and safe handling

The short version

Request the role → HR checks the details → management decides → HR prepares the hiring details → candidates are screened and interviewed.

Sign in and find your way around

Signing in

- 1 Open the McLink Recruitment Portal.**
Use the link provided by your organisation.
- 2 Choose “Sign in with Google”.**
Use your McLink Group Google Workspace account.
- 3 Start from the Dashboard.**
Your account permissions decide which areas are available.

If you cannot sign in

Make sure you are using your company account, not a personal Google account. If access is still denied, contact HR or the portal administrator.

The main menu

Menu item	What it is for
Dashboard	A quick view of hiring activity and the main steps in the process.
Role Requests	Create, find, filter, and follow staffing requests.
Resume Screening	For HR: upload several resumes and follow their progress.
Applicants	For reviewers: find candidates, read their information, and record decisions.
Bookings	For HR: view interview times and scheduled appointments.
Settings	View shared portal and calendar settings. Only authorised people can change them.
User Accounts	For administrators: add people and control what they can do.
Profile	View your name, department, and access.

Who does what?

The portal shows only the actions a person is allowed to use. The names below describe the usual responsibilities; one person may have more than one responsibility.

Requester

Creates a staffing request and follows the requests they submitted.

Usually sees: Dashboard, Role Requests, Profile.

HR or Recruiter

Reviews role details, prepares hiring information, screens candidates, arranges interviews, and manages the hiring list.

Usually sees: Role Requests, Resume Screening, Applicants, Bookings.

Department Head

Checks requests for their own department. They may have a view-only role request list unless HR has given more access.

Usually sees: Department Role Requests and relevant records.

Management approver

Reviews the business need and approves, returns, holds, or rejects a role request.

Usually sees: Role Requests and Applicants, but not HR operating tools unless separately authorised.

Interviewer

Reviews the information needed for interviews. Interview times and candidate links are provided by the portal.

Access may be limited to the information needed for the interview.

Administrator

Manages user access and, where authorised, shared settings and the interview calendar connection.

Give administrator access only to people who need it.

What you see may be different from a colleague

This is normal. If you need a menu item or action that is missing, ask HR or the portal administrator to review your access.

Create a new role request

Use a role request when your team needs an additional employee or needs to replace someone. Take a few minutes to gather the information before starting.

Before you begin

- ☐ Know the job title and department.
- ☐ Know whether this is a staff addition or a replacement.
- ☐ Have a clear description of the work and the reason for the request.
- ☐ Know the number of people needed and the target hiring date.
- ☐ Have the salary or budget information available if required by your process.

Steps

- 1 Open Role Requests, then select “Create Role Request”.**
- 2 Complete the role details.**

Enter the request type, department, employment type, job title, number of vacancies, and target hiring date.
- 3 Explain the need.**

For a replacement, name the employee or position being replaced. For any request, explain why the role is needed.
- 4 Add HR interview and screening questions if you have them.**

These questions help HR understand what to look for. They can be refined later.
- 5 Review and submit.**

The requester’s name and email are filled from the signed-in account. You cannot change those details in the form.

Tip: use the job description helper

If you have a job description file, upload it in the form or paste the description, then choose the option to fill in the form from it. Always check the suggested details before submitting.

What happens after submission?

The request is sent to HR for discussion. The requester can follow it from [Role Requests](#). A normal saved draft is not a submitted request and does not publish a job.

Review and approve a role request

Open a request from the Role Requests list to read the details, comments, history, and available actions.

Finding a request

- Use the **Status** filter to see requests at a particular step.
- Search by job title, role number, department, or requester.
- Use the sort options to find the newest request or the request with the nearest target date.
- Select **Refresh** if another person may have updated the request.

What the status means

Status	Plain meaning	Typical next step
Draft	Still being prepared.	Complete and submit it.
Pending HR Discussion	HR needs to review the request.	HR checks the details and discusses any changes.
Pending Management Approval	Management needs to decide.	Approve, return, hold, or reject.
Returned for Revision	More information or changes are needed.	Requester or HR updates the request.
On Hold	The request is paused.	Resume it when the business is ready.
Approved	The role has approval to move forward.	HR completes the hiring setup.
Recruitment Setup	HR is preparing screening and interview details.	Complete the setup and publish when ready.
Job Posted	The role is available for candidates.	Review applicants as they arrive.
Rejected	The request will not move forward.	Read the comments for the reason.

Making a decision

Choose the action that matches the decision, add a clear comment when useful, and confirm. If the request has changed since you opened it, refresh the page and review it again before trying the action.

Remember

Approval of a role is not the same as publishing a job. HR still needs to complete the recruitment setup and publish the role.

Prepare an approved role for hiring

HR uses Recruitment Setup to tell the portal what to look for in resumes and interviews. This page is normally available only to HR reviewers.

Complete the screening instructions

- **What should the interviewer listen for?** Describe the evidence that matters for this role.
- **License or certificate:** State whether one is required, preferred, or not needed.
- **Keywords to look for:** Add useful skills, tools, or terms separated by commas.
- **Transferable skills accepted:** Explain what related experience may count.
- **Minimum relevant experience:** Use a simple requirement such as “None”, “3 years”, or “5+ years”.
- **Approved salary or budget range:** Enter the agreed range if applicable.
- **Earliest availability instructions:** Explain any start-date question to ask.

Set evaluation fields and questions

The portal always considers the candidate’s score, recommendation, strengths, and concerns. You can add role-specific items and up to three custom items. Add three to five interview questions. The questions are asked as written, so keep them clear and fair.

Suggested questions may be shown for review. Treat them as a starting point, edit them as needed, and make sure the final questions are relevant to the job.

Use the publishing checklist

- ☐ Choose at least one place where the job will be posted.
- ☐ Choose the salary visibility option.
- ☐ Choose the license requirement.
- ☐ Choose whether an HR interview is required.

Save and move the role forward

Button	Use it when
Save	You want to save changes and continue working.
Mark as Recruitment Ready	The basic screening and interview information is complete.
Mark as Ready for Publishing	The publishing checklist is complete and HR has reviewed it.
Publish Role	The role is ready to appear for candidates.

Good practice

Read the script preview before saving. It shows the kind of conversation candidates will receive and helps you catch unclear wording.

Screen and manage applicants

Open the applicant list

Choose **Applicants** to see the candidate list. Use the search box to find a candidate, role, email, or application number. Use the role and stage filters to narrow the list. Choose 10, 25, or 50 rows per page.

Understand the summary cards

Applications

Total applications in the available history.

Resume Screened

Applications that have been processed and are ready for review.

Voice Interview

Candidates with activity in the phone interview stage.

HR Interview

Candidates who have moved beyond the phone interview stage.

Read an applicant record

Select **View** beside a candidate. The record brings together contact information, role, resume information, screening result, interview activity, and history. Use the linked resume only for recruitment purposes.

Send a personal application link

HR can invite one person to apply for one published role. The link opens the familiar candidate application page with the role and invited person's details already prepared.

- 1 Open **Resume Screening**.**
- 2 Choose the published role.**
Only roles that are ready to accept applications can be selected.
- 3 Enter the candidate's name and email address.**
Check the spelling carefully before continuing.
- 4 Select "Generate application link", then copy it.**
Send the link privately to the intended candidate.
- 5 Check Applicants after the candidate submits.**
The link is for one successful application only. If it expires or has already been used, generate a new one.

Keep invitation links private

The link is tied to the selected role and invited candidate. Do not post it in a group chat or send it to someone else.

Common applicant stages

Stage	What it means
Resume HR Review	The resume has been received and needs a human review.
Resume Approved	The candidate can move to the phone interview step.
Voice Booking Pending	The candidate needs to choose a phone interview time.
Voice Interview Scheduled	A phone interview time has been booked.
Voice HR Review	The phone interview result is ready for HR to review.
Approved for HR Interview	The candidate can choose a final HR interview time.
HR Interview Scheduled	A final HR interview time has been booked.
Passed HR Interview	The candidate passed the final interview step.
Rejected	The candidate will not move to the next step.

Deleting a record is permanent

Deleting an applicant also removes related screening information, history, and interview times. Check carefully before confirming.

Upload several resumes at once

HR can screen a group of resumes for one published role from **Resume Screening**. Each file is handled once for that role, and progress appears on the page.

Upload from your computer

1 Choose the published role.

Pick the role that matches every resume in this batch.

2 Add the files.

Drag them into the box or click the box to choose them. PDF, DOC, and DOCX files are accepted. You can add up to 25 files at a time, with a 10 MB limit per file.

3 Select “Start screening”.

The portal sends the resumes for processing and shows each one in the queue.

4 Watch the progress.

The list updates automatically. You can also choose “Refresh status”.

5 Review the applicants.

When processing is complete, choose “View Processed Applicants” to begin the human review.

Upload from the shared Drive folder

If your team uses the shared Google Drive folder, choose the role first and then select **Upload from Google Drive**. Put each resume inside the correct role and month folder. Do not put resumes directly in the role’s top-level folder.

Queue messages

Message	What to do
Queued	Wait. The file has been accepted and is waiting to be processed.
Processing	Wait. The portal is reading and checking the resume.
Completed / Screened	Open the applicant list and review the candidate.
Skipped	The file was already handled for this role.
Failed	Check the file and choose “Retry failed”. Use a readable, unlocked PDF, DOC, or DOCX.

Important

Automatic screening is an aid for HR, not a final hiring decision. Always review the resume and supporting information yourself.

Arrange and follow interviews

View the interview calendar

HR can open **Bookings** to see monthly availability and appointments. Use the role and interview-type filters to focus the view. Choose a date to see open times, scheduled candidates, completed interviews, and conflicts.

Add HR availability

1. Choose **+ HR Availability**.
2. Choose an approved role.
3. Choose **Refresh availability** to check the shared HR calendar.
4. Ask the candidate to use the booking link they received.

The candidate sees individual available times. They do not see the full internal calendar.

When a candidate books

The selected time becomes a scheduled appointment, the candidate receives a confirmation, and the calendar is updated. The portal also records the time zone so the candidate and HR see the same appointment time.

If a candidate does not attend

Open the date details, find the scheduled appointment, and choose **Mark No Show** after the interview time has started. Confirm the action. This keeps the attendance record clear and allows the team to decide whether to offer another time.

Calendar connection

Interview availability comes from the shared HR calendar. If it is not connected, ask the person who manages Settings to reconnect or check the calendar.

For candidates: applying and booking

Apply for a role

1 Open the job application page.

For a personal invitation, open the link sent by HR. The role and your name may already be filled in.

2 Enter your details.

Provide your name, email address, country, and mobile number.

3 Attach your resume.

Use a readable PDF, DOC, or DOCX file and check that the file is the correct version.

4 Review the privacy and consent message.

Continue only when you understand and agree to the stated use of your information.

5 Submit the application once.

A confirmation message means the application was received. Sending it again may create another application.

Book a phone interview

Open the private booking link in the invitation email. Enter your local mobile number without the country code, choose a date, choose a time, and confirm. Keep the confirmation email.

Book an HR interview

If HR invites you to the next step, open the new booking link and choose from the available times. The page shows whether the interview is scheduled, completed, or no longer available.

Keep booking links private

These links are personal. Do not forward them to another person or post them in a group chat. If the link does not work, contact the recruitment team and ask for a new invitation.

Common questions

“I cannot see a role or applicant.”

Your access may limit you to your own requests or your department. Ask HR to confirm that you have the right access.

“My request is not moving.”

Check the status and latest comment on the request. It may be waiting for HR or management, returned for more information, or on hold.

“The role was approved but candidates cannot apply.”

Approval is only one step. HR must complete the Recruitment Setup checklist and publish the role.

“A resume failed.”

Make sure it is a readable, unlocked PDF, DOC, or DOCX file and no larger than 10 MB. Try the retry option. If it still fails, ask HR to check the file or enter the candidate another way.

“The calendar shows no times.”

Check the role and interview-type filters, choose the correct month, and refresh. If there are still no times, ask the calendar administrator to check the shared HR calendar.

“The page says someone else changed the record.”

Refresh the page, read the latest information, and then try again. This prevents one person’s changes from replacing another person’s work.

Good practice

Do

- Use clear, job-related information.
- Check details before submitting or publishing.
- Keep candidate information private.
- Use human judgment alongside screening results.
- Add useful comments when returning or rejecting a request.

Do not

- Share private booking links.
- Use personal accounts for company recruitment work.
- Make a final decision based only on an automated score.
- Upload a resume to the wrong role.
- Delete records unless you are sure they should be removed.

Need more help?

Take a screenshot of the message, note the role or application number, and contact HR or the portal administrator. Do not include passwords or private booking links.

This guide describes the McLink Recruitment Portal interface and usual hiring process. Your organisation's access rules and hiring policies always take priority.